Six work orders released in November 2026, and three expressions evaluated for each

WorkOrderNumber	Status	ClosedDate	ClosedDate = NULL	ClosedDate IS NULL	COALESCE(ClosedDate, 'open')
WO-2026-013474	Closed	2026-11-17	NULL: not kept	false: not kept	2026-11-17
WO-2026-013475	Closed	2026-11-17	NULL: not kept	false: not kept	2026-11-17
WO-2026-013477	Released	NULL	NULL: not kept	true: kept	open
WO-2026-013478	Released	NULL	NULL: not kept	true: kept	open
WO-2026-013848	Completed	NULL	NULL: not kept	true: kept	open
WO-2026-013850	Completed	NULL	NULL: not kept	true: kept	open

An ordinary comparison with NULL, such as =, is never true, so = NULL keeps no row, closed or open. IS NULL is true for the work orders with no ClosedDate, and COALESCE shows a stand-in value where the date is missing.